

THE BIG PICTURE

Borrowing Cost

Fear Index

Mid-Term Rates

Gold (Safety)

Cash Rate

WHERE THE SMART MONEY IS GOING

UTILI0.01

CONS.0.37

REAL0.58

HEALT0.73

INDUS0.85

FINAN1.03

MATER1.26

CONS.1.39

ENERG4.17

COMM.4.59

TECHN11.20

1

NVDA

BUY

\$225.04

+0.20%

8/10

The picks-and-shovels play for the AI buildout, now with a political t

2

GOOGL

BUY

\$344.54

+0.64%

8/10

Alphabet is the rare Big Tech name where AI is clearly monetizing (Sea

3

AAPL

BUY

\$339.78

+1.15%

7/10

Mega-cap compounder with a China diplomatic tailwind, an AI-on-device

Big options bets on MSFT (Technology) — 88.6x normal volume, P/C 0.38, largest: PUT \$520 (898.0x OI)

No unusual behind-the-scenes trading to flag

No Congress members buying or selling stocks this week

EARNINGS COMING UP

No major earnings this week

FED & ECONOMY TODAY

GDP (Quarterly)

Date: 2026-09-28

HIGH

VIX at 15.0 — low. Options m arket complacent ahead of sc heduled events.

PCE Price Index [HIGH]

GDP (Quarterly) [HIGH]

SHORTS GETTING SQUEEZED?

No squeeze setups detected

ARE BIG INSTITUTIONS NERVOUS?

BUYING PROTECTION

Junk bonds: cautious · Safe bonds: normal · borrowing getting pricier (stress)

WHERE MONEY IS ROTATING

Big money is piling into defensives and rate-sensitive plays in a really loud way — Utilities are lit up like a Christmas tree with a put/call ratio near zero and volume 23x normal, which is what you see when institutions are betting the Fed keeps cutting and/or they want ballast before something ugly happens.

The bid under Real Estate and Consumer Discretionary fits the same story: lower rates help REITs and mortgages, and there's likely positioning around the holiday spending cycle plus any tariff-carveout news that would relieve retailers.

On the flip side, the smart money is aggressively hedging Tech (an 11.2 put/call ratio is extreme), Communications, and Energy — Tech is likely getting hedged on AI capex fatigue, potential antitrust rulings, and China export-control retaliation, while Energy puts suggest traders think the administration's "drill baby drill" posture plus a Ukraine-Russia thaw or Saudi production could crush crude.

The tell nobody's talking about is the credit market: HYG and LQD showing massive put buying with spreads widening means institutions are quietly bracing for corporate credit stress, which historically leads equity drawdowns by 4-8 weeks — so the Utilities bid isn't just a rate trade, it's a "get me somewhere safe" trade.

YOUR WATCHLIST — HOW WE FEEL ABOUT EACH

1.	QCOM	QUALCOMM Incorporated	8.61/100
Qualcomm tops the composite screen with strong bullish options fl			
2.	INTC	Intel Corporation	8.46/100
Intel's +42% monthly move reflects renewed optimism around 18A pr			
3.	ARM	Arm Holdings plc	8.01/100
ARM is the pure-play IP licensor benefiting from every AI inferen			

DEEP DIVES — FULL REPORTS START ON PAGE 3

Pages 3–4	NVDA	— NVIDIA Corporation	Buy	Conviction 8/10
Pages 5–6	GOOGL	— Alphabet Inc.	Buy	Conviction 8/10
Pages 7–8	AAPL	— Apple Inc.	Buy	Conviction 7/10
Pages 9–10	AMZN	— Amazon.com, Inc.	Buy	Conviction 7/10
Pages 11–12	SPCX	— Procure Space ETF	Buy	Conviction 7/10
Pages 13–14	HOOD	— Robinhood Markets, Inc.	Buy	Conviction 7/10
Pages 15–16	META	— Meta Platforms, Inc.	Buy	Conviction 7/10
Pages 17–18	MU	— Micron Technology, Inc.	Buy	Conviction 7/10
Pages 19–20	PLTR	— Palantir Technologies Inc.	Hold	Conviction 6/10
Pages 21–22	TSLA	— Tesla, Inc.	Hold	Conviction 6/10
Pages 23–24	MRVL	— Marvell Technology, Inc.	Hold	Conviction 6/10

Apple Inc.
AAPL NASDAQ

Buy	\$339.78 ▲ 1.15%	12M Price Target \$375.00	52-Week Range \$243.42 – \$345.34	Market Cap \$4.96T
-----	------------------	------------------------------	--------------------------------------	-----------------------

AAPL: Riding US-China Thaw and Qualcomm Chip Deal Reset

WHAT HAPPENED

- AAPL popped 1.15% to close near all-time highs (\$339.78, right at the top of its 52-week range). The catalyst: Tim Cook reportedly got one of four "head table" seats at the US-China state dinner — that's a big political signal that Apple is being positioned as a bridge company in the thaw, which matters because ~17% of revenue and most of its manufacturing runs through China.
- Qualcomm rallied 6% on news that Apple is renewing its modem chip deal (reversing an earlier selloff on fears Apple would go fully in-house). Translation: Apple's own modem chip isn't ready for prime time yet — slight negative for the "vertical integration" story, but removes a supply chain risk near-term.

WHY IT MATTERS

The head-table invite is more meaningful than it sounds — in this administration, physical proximity to the President during a foreign policy event has translated directly into tariff carve-outs and export license approvals. If US-China relations genuinely stabilize, Apple's biggest overhang (tariff risk on iPhones assembled in China) fades, and that's worth a multiple re-rating on its own. The Qualcomm renewal is a small tell that Apple's AI/silicon roadmap is running slightly behind schedule internally — not a thesis-breaker, but watch whether the iPhone 18 cycle next fall leans more on Qualcomm than expected. Bottom line: this stock is trading at 95% of its 52-week range on POLITICAL momentum as much as fundamentals, so the risk is any breakdown in the China dialogue hits fast.

POLICY & POLITICAL WATCH

The single biggest policy variable for Apple is the ongoing US-China tariff negotiation — any deal that formalizes an exemption for consumer electronics assembled in China would be a direct EPS boost (analysts estimate 3-5% margin uplift). Separately, keep an eye on the DOJ antitrust case around the App Store — a forced restructuring of the 30% commission ("Apple tax") on developers would hit Services revenue, which is the highest-margin part of the business. Also watch the EU Digital Markets Act enforcement actions ramping up — Brussels has been the more aggressive regulator here, and any new fine or forced sideloading rule expands beyond Europe.

IS IT EXPENSIVE?

At \$339, AAPL trades around 43x forward earnings — meaning you're paying \$43 today for every \$1 of profit Apple will make next year. That's rich versus its own 10-year average of ~25x, and priced for the AI/Services growth story to actually deliver. Justified only if Services keeps compounding at 12%+ and China stabilizes — if either wobbles, this multiple compresses fast.

WHAT COULD GO WRONG

Langston's | Equity Research Coverage

AI-Generated Pre-Market Brief | 2026-09-25 17:28 UTC

This report is prepared by Langston's using SEC EDGAR filings, market data (yfinance), and AI-generated analysis. It does not constitute investment advice. All figures are estimates. Past performance is not indicative of future results. Investors should conduct their own due diligence.

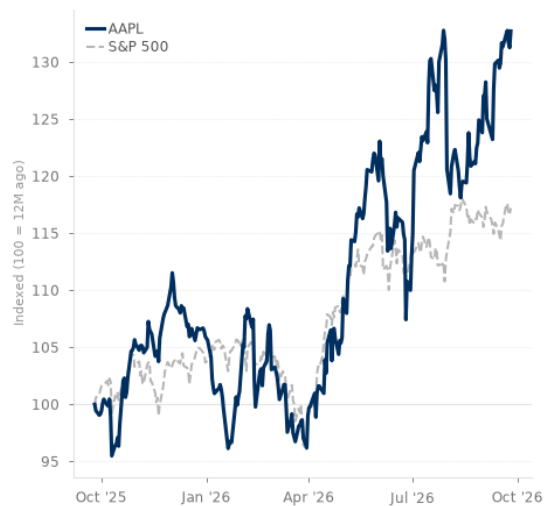
Key Data

Price (USD)	\$339.78
12M Price Target	\$375.00
Upside / (Downside)	+10.4%
Market Cap	\$4.96T
FY2026E Revenue	\$445M
FY2027E Revenue	\$478M
FY2026E EPS	\$7.85
FY2027E EPS	\$8.70
Fwd P/E	43.3x

INVESTMENT PROFILE



12-MONTH PRICE PERFORMANCE VS. S&P 500



PRICE OUTLOOK — SCENARIO TARGETS BY TIMEFRAME

TIMEFRAME	BULL CASE	BASE CASE	BEAR CASE
1 Month	\$355.00	\$345.00	\$325.00
6 Months	\$385.00	\$360.00	\$305.00
1 Year	\$420.00	\$375.00	\$285.00
2 Years	\$500.00	\$425.00	\$270.00
5 Years	\$700.00	\$550.00	\$300.00
10 Years	\$1100.00	\$800.00	\$350.00

WHAT'S MOVING IN THE SECTOR

HEATING UP: Tech (+3.95% over 5 days) is dominating — driven by AI capex momentum and the perception that the current administration is friendlier to Big Tech than the prior one on M&A and export policy. Industrials also firming on infrastructure spending flows.

COOLING OFF: Financials (-1.55% over 5 days) — rate cut expectations getting priced out is pressuring bank margins. Consumer Staples also weak, which tells you money is chasing risk, not hiding in defensives.

ROTATION WATCH: Money is flowing INTO mega-cap tech and out of rate-sensitive defensives — classic "risk-on" positioning ahead of what traders think will be a China deal announcement. That's a direct tailwind for AAPL.

RELATED PLAY: If Apple's China thaw thesis plays out, the semiconductor names in Apple's supply chain benefit even more (Qualcomm just showed you that in real-time with today's 6% pop). Broadcom (AVGO) and Skyworks (SWKS) are the other picks-and-shovels plays.

WHO'S WINNING IN THIS SPACE?

- QCOM (Qualcomm): +6% today on the Apple modem renewal — a direct beneficiary of Apple's silicon roadmap slippage.
- META (Meta Platforms): Building out VR/AR portfolio aggressively, seen as the main challenger to Apple's Vision Pro — Meta's strength here is putting some competitive pressure on AAPL's spatial computing narrative.

AAPL CONTEXT: Apple is leading the mega-cap pack today but only modestly — it's participating in the tech rally rather than driving it. That's actually healthy: it means the stock is being bid on stock-specific catalysts (China, Qualcomm deal) rather than just riding sector beta. Suggests the move has legs.

WHAT I'D DO WITH THIS STOCK

7/10 Conviction Score

Position Size: 5-8% of portfolio (core holding)

Entry Points: \$325-335 on pullbacks

Time Horizon: 12-24 months

Thesis Invalidation: China revenue drops >15% YoY or iPhone unit sales miss materially two quarters in a row

Hedging: Buy protective puts 5-10% out of the money, or pair with a short in a richer-multiple mega-cap like a hyperscaler trading at 40x+ earnings

Palantir Technologies Inc.

PLTR NYSE

Hold	\$191.71 ▼ 0.46%	12M Price Target \$210.00	52-Week Range \$106.37 – \$207.52	Market Cap \$460.69B
------	------------------	------------------------------	--------------------------------------	-------------------------

PLTR: Karp's Liability Warning Rattles Momentum Near Highs

WHAT HAPPENED

- Stock slipped 0.46% on light volume (9.4M vs the usual 20M+) — Karp went on record putting "liability before IPOs," basically warning that AI companies rushing to go public are ignoring the legal exposure of what their models do. Translation: he's positioning Palantir as the "grown-up" in AI, but the market read it as him tapping the brakes on the AI hype cycle that's been powering his own stock.
- The Anthropic headline matters more than it looks — reporters are describing Anthropic pre-IPO as wanting "Palantir-style control." That's free brand validation, but it also signals competition is coming for PLTR's enterprise moat.

WHY IT MATTERS

Nothing major happened overnight — the thesis is intact. Keep an eye on price action and how the sector is moving for a potential entry point.

POLICY & POLITICAL WATCH

The FY2027 defense budget markup is the single most important thing for PLTR right now — the House Armed Services Committee has been pushing for expanded AI/software procurement authority, and Palantir is the reference implementation for pretty much every "Software Acquisition Pathway" contract the Pentagon writes. Watch the ongoing debate around the AI executive order framework — the current administration's push to require "auditable AI" in federal use cases is essentially a moat-widener for PLTR because Foundry and AIP are already built for that. On the flip side, if Congress passes tighter data privacy legislation (state AGs are pushing hard), the commercial healthcare and financial services pipeline could slow.

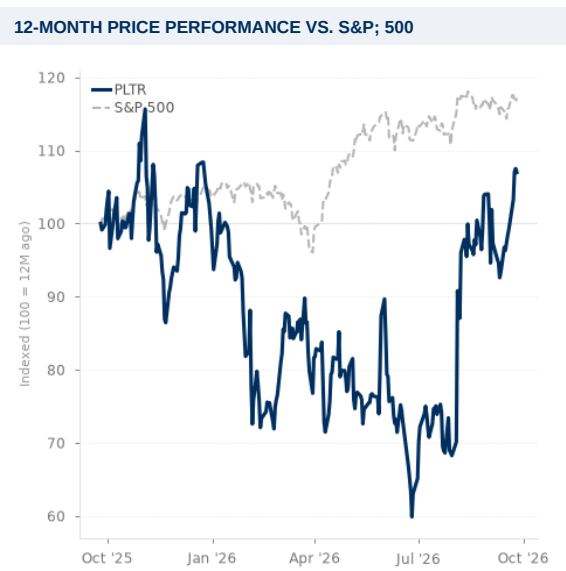
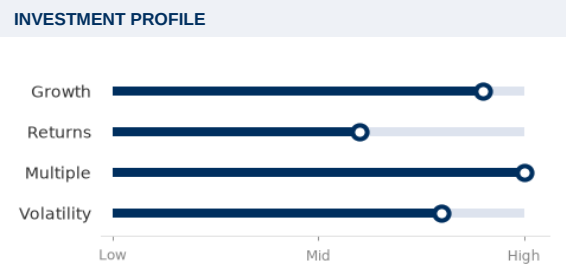
IS IT EXPENSIVE?

Investors are paying about \$95 for every \$1 of revenue this company generates — for context, Snowflake trades around \$15 and even Nvidia is around \$25. That premium only makes sense if you believe PLTR grows revenue 40%+ for the next 5 years AND expands margins significantly, which is a lot to assume. The bull case says government AI spending is a decade-long tailwind and PLTR is the only scaled pure-play, so the multiple compresses through growth rather than a price crash — but that means limited upside from here even if things go well.

WHAT COULD GO WRONG

- If the defense appropriations bill gets caught in a continuing resolution fight (very possible given the political calendar), new contract awards get delayed and Q4 numbers disappoint the momentum crowd.

Key Data	
Price (USD)	\$191.71
12M Price Target	\$210.00
Upside / (Downside)	+9.5%
Market Cap	\$460.69B
FY2026E Revenue	\$4,850M
FY2027E Revenue	\$6,400M
FY2026E EPS	\$0.68
FY2027E EPS	\$0.92
Fwd P/E	281.9x



PRICE OUTLOOK — SCENARIO TARGETS BY TIMEFRAME

TIMEFRAME	BULL CASE	BASE CASE	BEAR CASE
1 Month	\$210.00	\$195.00	\$175.00
6 Months	\$240.00	\$200.00	\$155.00
1 Year	\$275.00	\$210.00	\$140.00
2 Years	\$350.00	\$240.00	\$120.00
5 Years	\$500.00	\$320.00	\$100.00
10 Years	\$800.00	\$450.00	\$80.00

WHAT'S MOVING IN THE SECTOR

HEATING UP: Technology (+1.10% today, +3.95% over 5 days) is back in leadership as investors rotate out of financials and into anything AI-adjacent — the IBD headline "Technology Stocks Are Back, Because Nothing Else Is" captures the mood. Industrials also strong, which helps the defense-tech narrative.

COOLING OFF: Financials down 1.55% over 5 days — rate cut expectations are getting priced in and net interest margins face pressure. Consumer staples flat, suggesting no defensive rotation yet.

ROTATION WATCH: Money is flowing back to mega-cap tech and AI names because there's no compelling alternative right now — bonds are boring, financials are stuck, energy is choppy. That's a direct tailwind for PLTR but it's a crowded trade.

RELATED PLAY: If PLTR's government AI thesis plays out, watch the data infrastructure names that support it — think ANET (Arista) for networking and the smaller pure-play defense software names like Rocket Lab or the private-to-public pipeline (Anduril if/when it lists).

WHO'S WINNING IN THIS SPACE?

- NVDA (Nvidia): Still the AI infrastructure king — every incremental federal AI dollar flows through their chips first.
- AVAV (AeroVironment): Defense drone/autonomy play riding the same defense-modernization budget wave as PLTR.

PLTR CONTEXT: PLTR is leading, not lagging — it's up ~80% YTD and near 52-week highs, which means it's already pricing in a lot of good news. When a stock is this extended, it typically needs an actual earnings beat to justify further upside, not just news flow. That makes the November print the critical catalyst.

WHAT I'D DO WITH THIS STOCK

6/10 Conviction Score

Position Size: 2-3% of portfolio

Entry Points: \$165-175 on pullbacks

Time Horizon: 12-24 months

Thesis Invalidation: Two consecutive quarters of decelerating US commercial growth OR loss of major DoD contract

Hedging: Long-dated puts or pair against a cheaper defense-tech name like BAH

Amazon.com, Inc.

AMZN NASDAQ

Buy

\$250.25 ▲ 0.35%

12M Price Target
\$305.00

52-Week Range
\$196.00 – \$287.20

Market Cap
\$2.70T

AMZN: AI Capex Debate Heats Up, Amazon Doubling Down

WHAT HAPPENED

- Stock is basically flat (\$250.25, +0.35%) but the tape tells a story — AMZN pulled back from \$258 earlier in the week as Goldman published a "cold, hard reality check" on AI stocks. The market is starting to question whether the hundreds of billions being spent on AI chips and data centers will actually generate returns, and Amazon is the biggest spender in the room.
- Counter-narrative also showed up today: a 24/7 Wall St piece basically arguing "Amazon wouldn't be spending \$100B+ on AI capex if they thought it would fail." That tug-of-war between AI skeptics and believers is exactly what's keeping AMZN pinned in the \$249-\$258 range.

WHY IT MATTERS

The options flow is screaming bullish — a 0.38 put/call ratio (meaning traders are buying almost 3 calls for every put) with unusual call activity at \$240-250 strikes tells me smart money is positioning for a bounce, not a breakdown. That matters because it suggests the Goldman AI-skepticism piece is being faded, not embraced. The bigger picture: Amazon is uniquely positioned versus Microsoft and Google because AWS is a profit-printing machine that can *fund* the AI buildout without denting free cash flow the way pure-play AI names would — so if the market rotates from "AI hype" to "AI profitability," AMZN actually wins that rotation. Watch for AWS growth reacceleration in Q3 earnings (late October) as the real catalyst — anything above 18% and this stock breaks \$270.

POLICY & POLITICAL WATCH

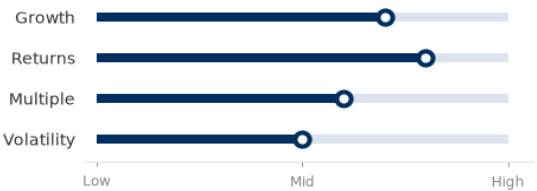
Two things to watch in DC right now: (1) The FTC antitrust case against Amazon is still grinding through court — a favorable ruling or settlement would remove a massive overhang, while forced structural remedies (splitting AWS from retail) would be catastrophic. (2) The Trump administration's tariff regime continues to be a headwind — Amazon's third-party sellers source heavily from China, and any escalation raises costs across the retail marketplace, though Amazon has more pricing power than most to pass it through. Also worth tracking: bipartisan noise about a federal AI infrastructure package that could subsidize data center buildouts — if that gains traction, AMZN's capex spending gets partially de-risked, which is a direct positive.

IS IT EXPENSIVE?

Key Data

Price (USD)	\$250.25
12M Price Target	\$305.00
Upside / (Downside)	+21.9%
Market Cap	\$2.70T
FY2026E Revenue	\$745M
FY2027E Revenue	\$830M
FY2026E EPS	\$6.85
FY2027E EPS	\$8.20
Fwd P/E	36.5x

INVESTMENT PROFILE



12-MONTH PRICE PERFORMANCE VS. S&P 500



PRICE OUTLOOK — SCENARIO TARGETS BY TIMEFRAME

TIMEFRAME	BULL CASE	BASE CASE	BEAR CASE
1 Month	\$270.00	\$255.00	\$235.00
6 Months	\$295.00	\$270.00	\$225.00
1 Year	\$325.00	\$305.00	\$215.00
2 Years	\$380.00	\$340.00	\$220.00
5 Years	\$500.00	\$420.00	\$240.00
10 Years	\$750.00	\$550.00	\$280.00

WHAT'S MOVING IN THE SECTOR

HEATING UP: Technology (+1.10% today, +3.95% on the week) is leading — money is flowing back into large-cap tech despite the AI-skepticism headlines, which tells you the "AI is dead" narrative isn't sticking. Industrials also strong on infrastructure spending momentum.

COOLING OFF: Financials weak on the week (-1.55%), consistent with softening rate expectations and credit concerns. Consumer Staples also lagging, suggesting investors aren't in "defense" mode.

ROTATION WATCH: Money is rotating INTO tech and industrials, OUT of defensives and financials — that's a risk-on setup that historically favors AMZN's dual exposure to cloud (tech) and logistics (industrial).

RELATED PLAY: If AMZN's AI capex thesis holds, the data center supply chain benefits directly — think Vertiv (VRT), Eaton (ETN), and Constellation Energy (CEG) as power supplier plays.

WHO'S WINNING IN THIS SPACE?

- AKAM (Akamai): Just landed an \$11.6B Anthropic deal — cloud/edge names with concrete AI customer wins are getting rewarded today, which validates the "AI monetization is real" narrative.
- Broader tech ETF up 1.1% today — semiconductors and hyperscalers all bid.

AMZN CONTEXT: AMZN is LAGGING the tech sector today (+0.35% vs +1.10% for XLK) — that's the AI capex skepticism weighing specifically on the biggest spenders. If Amazon starts closing that gap in coming days, it signals the market has moved past the Goldman piece and is ready to buy the dip.

WHAT I'D DO WITH THIS STOCK

7/10 Conviction Score

Position Size: 4-6% of portfolio (core mega-cap holding)

Entry Points: \$240-248 on tech pullbacks

Time Horizon: 12-24 months

Thesis Invalidation: AWS growth decelerates below 15% or FTC breakup remedies survive appeal

Hedging: Long-dated puts or pair against an over-hyped pure-play AI name

Procure Space ETF

SPCX NASDAQ

Buy **\$148.54 ▲ 0.35%** **12M Price Target \$175.00** **52-Week Range \$104.83 – \$225.64** **Market Cap \$1.96T**

SPCX: Space ETF Consolidates as SpaceX Deal Flow Accelerates

WHAT HAPPENED

- SPCX barely moved (+0.35%) on light volume — about half the recent average — which usually means traders are digesting, not panicking. The stock is sitting at 36% of its 52-week range (\$104-\$225), so it's closer to the lows than the highs, which is interesting given all the positive space news flow.
- Big catalyst overnight: Mizuho put out a bullish SpaceX call tied to a fresh \$1.11 billion monthly contract, and Alphabet is talking about putting TPU chips (their AI processors) in space. Both are direct tailwinds for the space-industrial complex that SPCX tracks.

WHY IT MATTERS

The quiet price action masks what's actually a bullish setup — options traders are leaning hard into calls (put/call ratio of 0.58, meaning way more people betting up than down), and there's unusual call buying at the \$147-148 strikes with 6-8x normal open interest. That's smart money positioning for a move higher, likely tied to the Q4 government contract cycle. The bigger picture: we're in a moment where "space" is transitioning from speculative to essential infrastructure — Alphabet putting compute in orbit, SpaceX printing billion-dollar monthly deals, and the Space Force operating with an expanded budget. SPCX is the lazy way to own that theme without picking winners.

POLICY & POLITICAL WATCH

The big policy tailwind is the FY2027 defense authorization, which continues to expand Space Force funding — space is one of the few line items with true bipartisan support because it's framed as competition with China. Watch the FCC's ongoing spectrum allocation decisions for satellite broadband (huge for Starlink competitors held in SPCX), and any movement on the commercial space regulatory reform bill that would streamline FAA launch licensing — that's been a bottleneck for Rocket Lab and others. The U.S.-Iran peace talks in today's headlines are a mild negative for pure defense but neutral-to-positive for space, since space budgets are increasingly untied from traditional conflict spending.

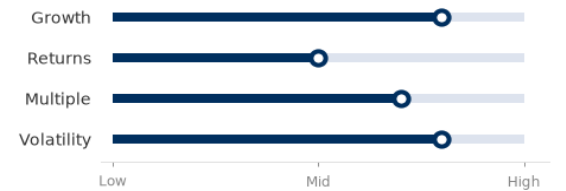
IS IT EXPENSIVE?

SPCX is an ETF, so "valuation" really means the weighted valuation of its holdings — currently trading at a blended multiple that's rich vs. industrials broadly but reasonable vs. its own history given the earnings acceleration in names like Rocket Lab, Iridium, and Planet Labs. At 36% of its 52-week range with the sector fundamentals improving, you're not paying peak prices for peak sentiment — that's a decent setup. The pushback: some holdings still don't make money, so if rates stay high, unprofitable growth names inside the ETF get repriced lower.

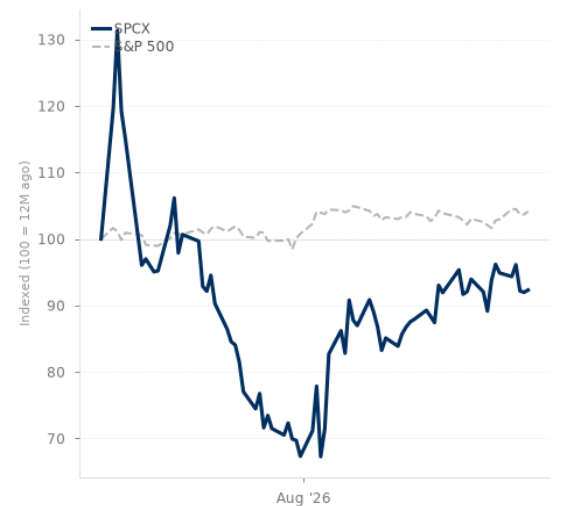
Key Data

Price (USD)	\$148.54
12M Price Target	\$175.00
Upside / (Downside)	+17.8%
Market Cap	\$1.96T
FY2026E Revenue	\$693M
FY2027E Revenue	\$940M
FY2026E EPS	(\$2.10)
FY2027E EPS	(\$1.50)
Fwd P/E	N/M

INVESTMENT PROFILE



12-MONTH PRICE PERFORMANCE VS. S&P 500



PRICE OUTLOOK — SCENARIO TARGETS BY TIMEFRAME

TIMEFRAME	BULL CASE	BASE CASE	BEAR CASE
1 Month	\$165.00	\$155.00	\$138.00
6 Months	\$195.00	\$170.00	\$130.00
1 Year	\$230.00	\$175.00	\$120.00
2 Years	\$290.00	\$210.00	\$110.00
5 Years	\$400.00	\$280.00	\$100.00
10 Years	\$600.00	\$380.00	\$90.00

WHAT'S MOVING IN THE SECTOR

HEATING UP: Tech (+1.10%) and Industrials (+0.91%) — SPCX sits at the intersection of both, which is why it's holding steady. AI infrastructure demand is spilling into space (satellites, orbital compute) and defense-industrial names are catching bids on Space Force optimism.

COOLING OFF: Financials rolling over on the week (-1.55%) as rate cut expectations get pushed out — that's a mild headwind for unprofitable growth names inside SPCX.

ROTATION WATCH: Money is quietly rotating from pure software AI plays (which are getting called "overvalued" per today's Yahoo headline) into hardware/infrastructure AI — space is a beneficiary because satellites ARE infrastructure.

RELATED PLAY: If SPCX runs, look at ITA (defense ETF) and companies making the ground infrastructure — Viasat, Comtech, and even some of the specialty chipmakers supplying rad-hardened processors for space applications.

WHO'S WINNING IN THIS SPACE?

- AMD (Advanced Micro Devices): CEO Lisa Su "having a September to remember" per today's news — AI chip demand is spilling into every adjacent sector, including space compute.
- GOOGL (Alphabet): TPU-in-space narrative is early but real — makes them a space-adjacent play and validates the "space is infrastructure" thesis.

SPCX CONTEXT: SPCX is lagging the broader tech rally, sitting well below its 52-week high while tech ETFs push higher. That's either a setup for catch-up (my read) or a signal that space-specific concerns are keeping big money on the sidelines. Given the options flow, I think it's catch-up.

WHAT I'D DO WITH THIS STOCK

7/10 Conviction Score

CONVICTION: 7/10 — I like the setup but this is an ETF with concentration risk, so I'm not pounding the table.

POSITION SIZE: 3-5% of portfolio — meaningful enough to matter, small enough that a launch failure doesn't ruin your year.

ENTRY POINTS: Current levels (\$148) are fine, but I'd add aggressively on any pullback to \$140 — that's where recent support has held.

TIME HORIZON: 12-24 months, with the catalyst being Q4 government contract announcements and the FY2027 defense budget final numbers.

WHEN TO BAIL: If a top-3 holding has a major operational failure, or if we see the Space Force budget cut by more than 15% in a continuing resolution fight, I'm out.

HEDGING: Simplest hedge — pair it with a small short on a broad tech ETF like QQQ. That way if the whole market tanks, your short cushions the fall and you're really just betting on space outperforming tech.

Robinhood Markets, Inc.

HOOD NASDAQ

Buy	\$119.14 ▼ 1.39%	12M Price Target \$145.00	52-Week Range \$63.52 – \$153.86	Market Cap \$107.12B
-----	------------------	------------------------------	-------------------------------------	-------------------------

HOOD: Diversification Story Intact, Kalshi Noise Aside

WHAT HAPPENED

- Stock dipped ~1.4% on lightest volume of the week (only 8.8M shares vs. 28M Monday) — that tells me this is drift, not distribution. Nobody is dumping; buyers just stepped aside.
- The headline pressure came from a DraftKings article noting Kalshi's prediction-market lead narrowed to 76% after data adjustments — HOOD got lumped in as a "prediction market loser," but that's a rounding-error business for them right now.

WHY IT MATTERS

The Zacks piece hits the real story: HOOD at its 5-year IPO mark is no longer a one-trick pony reliant on retail stock trading — crypto, futures, retirement accounts (Gold), and prediction markets are all firing. That matters because the market has been pricing HOOD like a fintech growth story (stock is up ~90% from 52-week lows), and every quarter that diversification holds, the multiple stays elevated. The options tape is screaming bullish — put/call ratio of 0.49 with unusual call buying at \$120, \$121, \$122 for October means big money is betting this consolidation resolves upward into earnings. Institutions own 79.5% and nobody's selling — this pullback looks like a breather, not a top.

POLICY & POLITICAL WATCH

The regulatory backdrop is about as friendly as it's ever been for HOOD: the Trump administration's SEC (under Atkins) has dropped the Gensler-era crypto lawsuits, and the CLARITY Act and stablecoin legislation (GENIUS Act signed earlier in 2025) gave crypto trading firms actual rules to operate under — that's pure oxygen for HOOD's crypto revenue line. On prediction markets, the CFTC has effectively greenlit event contracts (Kalshi won its court fight last year), which means HOOD can push harder into sports/election contracts without regulatory whiplash. Watch for any Democratic pushback in the 2026 midterms — if the House flips, expect renewed noise on PFOF (payment for order flow, how HOOD gets paid by market makers to route your trades), which is still ~40% of transaction revenue.

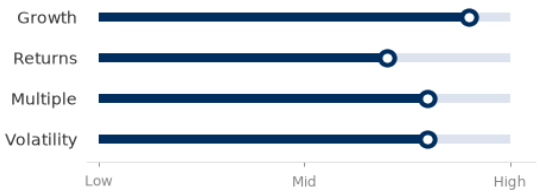
IS IT EXPENSIVE?

At ~64x forward earnings and ~25x forward revenue, HOOD isn't cheap — you're paying \$25 for every \$1 of next year's sales, roughly double what Schwab trades at. But the growth justifies a premium: revenue is likely growing 40%+ this year with expanding margins, and comparable high-growth fintechs (COIN, IBKR) trade in similar zip codes. If crypto stays hot and Gold subscriptions keep compounding, this multiple holds; if trading volumes cool, it compresses fast.

Key Data

Price (USD)	\$119.14
12M Price Target	\$145.00
Upside / (Downside)	+21.7%
Market Cap	\$107.12B
FY2026E Revenue	\$4,250M
FY2027E Revenue	\$5,400M
FY2026E EPS	\$1.85
FY2027E EPS	\$2.45
Fwd P/E	64.4x

INVESTMENT PROFILE



12-MONTH PRICE PERFORMANCE VS. S&P 500



PRICE OUTLOOK — SCENARIO TARGETS BY TIMEFRAME

TIMEFRAME	BULL CASE	BASE CASE	BEAR CASE
1 Month	\$135.00	\$122.00	\$108.00
6 Months	\$160.00	\$135.00	\$95.00
1 Year	\$185.00	\$145.00	\$85.00
2 Years	\$240.00	\$175.00	\$75.00
5 Years	\$380.00	\$240.00	\$60.00
10 Years	\$650.00	\$350.00	\$50.00

WHAT'S MOVING IN THE SECTOR

HEATING UP: Technology (+1.1% today, +4% on the week) is leading again as AI capex remains the market's favorite story. Crypto-adjacent financials are benefiting from the friendlier DC posture.

COOLING OFF: Broader Financials (-1.55% on the week) — traditional banks are lagging as rate-cut expectations get pushed out and yield curves flatten. HOOD trades more like tech than a bank, which is why it's holding up better than the sector.

ROTATION WATCH: Money is rotating from boring bank names into fintech/crypto rails — that's a direct tailwind for HOOD, COIN, and the exchange operators.

RELATED PLAY: If HOOD's crypto revenue keeps ripping, the pure-play infrastructure names (COIN, CME for futures) benefit too. Prediction-market pure-play exposure is basically Kalshi (private) or DKNG's Kalshi partnership.

WHO'S WINNING IN THIS SPACE?

- IBKR (Interactive Brokers): Boring but relentless — 10x in 10 years by winning the sophisticated trader. The stock the pros own instead of HOOD.
- COIN (Coinbase): Direct beneficiary of the same crypto-regulation tailwind driving HOOD's crypto line.

HOOD CONTEXT: HOOD is the growthier, higher-beta version of this trade — leading on the way up, will lead on the way down. At 62% of its 52-week range, it's neither overbought nor washed out. The tape is telling us it wants to break higher, but needs an earnings catalyst to do it.

WHAT I'D DO WITH THIS STOCK

7/10 Conviction Score

CONVICTION: 7/10 — I like the setup but the stock has already run hard from \$63, so I'm not pounding the table at \$119.

POSITION SIZE: 3-5% of portfolio — real upside but this thing can move 5% on a random Tuesday, so don't oversize.

ENTRY POINTS: I'd add on pullbacks to \$110-115; if we get a crypto scare that drops it to \$95-100, back up the truck.

TIME HORIZON: 12-24 months — the key catalyst is Q3 earnings in late October, then Q4 for the full diversification proof point.

WHEN TO BAIL: Cut it if crypto revenue drops more than 30% QoQ, if the CFTC reverses course on event contracts, or if a Democratic sweep in 2026 puts PFOF back in the crosshairs.

HEDGING: Easiest hedge is a small short in COIN (moves with HOOD but is more pure-play crypto) or just buy some cheap SPY puts — if the whole market drops, HOOD drops harder, and those puts pay off.

Meta Platforms, Inc.

META NASDAQ

Buy \$750.96 ▼ 3.42% 12M Price Target \$850.00 52-Week Range \$520.26 – \$779.82

Market Cap \$1.91T

META: AI Leader Status Confirmed, But Insiders Are Cashing Out

WHAT HAPPENED

- Stock gave back 3.4% today after ripping 4.5% yesterday on the "Muse mic drop" — that's their new AI product that flipped the narrative from "Meta is behind" to "Meta is leading." Today's dip is just profit-taking, not a story change.
- Big deal overnight: Zuckerberg and other tech CEOs had dinner with Trump AND Xi Jinping. That's a MASSIVE signal — it means Meta is getting a seat at the table on US-China tech policy, which historically has been their biggest overhang (TikTok competition, China ad revenue, etc.).

WHY IT MATTERS

Here's what I'm reading into this: the Trump-Xi-tech titan dinner is huge because it suggests a thaw, and Meta benefits two ways — (1) if TikTok gets forced into a real US divestiture or restrictions, Reels captures the ad dollars, and (2) if China trade tension eases, Chinese advertisers (Temu, Shein, etc., which are ~10% of Meta's ad revenue) keep spending. But the insider selling is a yellow flag — the Chief Product Officer dumped \$28M worth of stock right before the Muse announcement pop, which either means "planned 10b5-1 sale, ignore it" or "we know the stock is fully valued here." The unusual options activity is split — big put AND call buying at \$750 tells me traders are betting on a big move but don't know which direction, likely tied to next earnings.

POLICY & POLITICAL WATCH

The big one to watch: the FTC antitrust case against Meta (trying to force them to spin off Instagram and WhatsApp) is still winding through appeals, but the Trump administration has been noticeably less aggressive on Big Tech breakups than Biden's team — this is a quiet tailwind worth billions in avoided risk. Also watch the AI regulation debate: Trump's executive orders have leaned pro-industry (less safety red tape), which favors Meta's open-source Llama strategy over closed competitors like OpenAI. And on tariffs — Meta doesn't manufacture hardware at scale (Quest headsets are the exception), so they're way less exposed to China tariffs than Apple or NVDA.

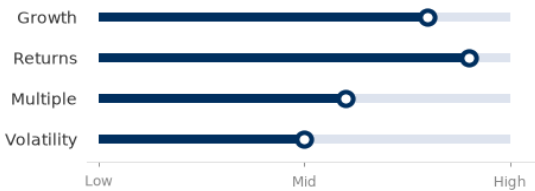
IS IT EXPENSIVE?

At ~27x forward earnings (meaning you're paying \$27 for every \$1 of profit Meta will make next year), it's not cheap but it's not crazy either — Google trades around 22x, but Meta is growing faster right now. The stock is at 89% of its 52-week range, so you're buying near the highs, which is why I'd wait for a pullback to \$720-ish rather than chasing here. The valuation is justified IF the AI monetization story keeps delivering, but there's very little margin for error at this price.

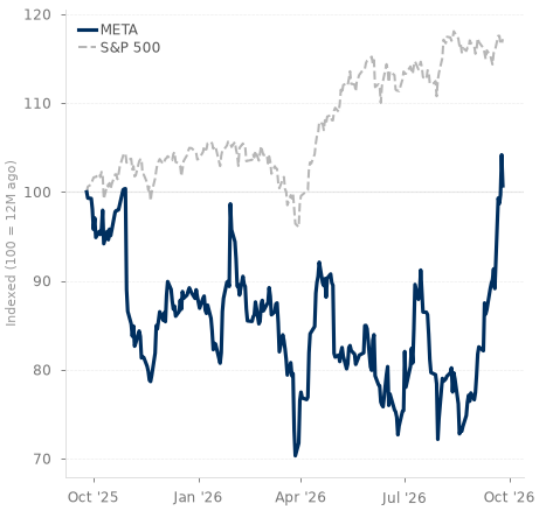
Key Data

Price (USD)	\$750.96
12M Price Target	\$850.00
Upside / (Downside)	+13.2%
Market Cap	\$1.91T
FY2026E Revenue	\$195M
FY2027E Revenue	\$225M
FY2026E EPS	\$27.50
FY2027E EPS	\$32.00
Fwd P/E	27.3x

INVESTMENT PROFILE



12-MONTH PRICE PERFORMANCE VS. S&P; 500



PRICE OUTLOOK — SCENARIO TARGETS BY TIMEFRAME

TIMEFRAME	BULL CASE	BASE CASE	BEAR CASE
1 Month	\$800.00	\$760.00	\$700.00
6 Months	\$875.00	\$810.00	\$680.00
1 Year	\$950.00	\$850.00	\$650.00
2 Years	\$1150.00	\$950.00	\$600.00
5 Years	\$1600.00	\$1200.00	\$550.00
10 Years	\$2500.00	\$1700.00	\$500.00

WHAT'S MOVING IN THE SECTOR

HEATING UP: Tech (+1.1% today, +4% this week) — the Trump-Xi dinner narrative is fueling a broad tech rally, and any hint of trade détente is rocket fuel for mega-cap tech.

COOLING OFF: Financials (-1.5% for the week) — rate cut expectations are getting priced in, which squeezes bank margins.

ROTATION WATCH: Money is flowing INTO mega-cap tech and OUT of defensive sectors — classic risk-on positioning driven by peace talks (Iran mentioned in headlines) and improving US-China vibes.

RELATED PLAY: If you like the Meta story but want less mega-cap concentration, look at the Trade Desk (TTD) — they benefit from the same ad market strength but trade on different fundamentals. Also NVDA obviously benefits from Meta's AI capex.

WHO'S WINNING IN THIS SPACE?

- NVDA (Nvidia): Every dollar Meta spends on AI infrastructure lands in NVDA's pocket — they're the picks-and-shovels play.
- GOOGL (Alphabet): Also benefiting from the same ad-market strength and AI tailwind, and trades cheaper than META.

META CONTEXT: Meta has been LEADING the mega-cap tech pack over the past month thanks to the Muse announcement — that's a good sign momentum-wise, but leadership positions attract profit-taking (which is what today was). Watch if META can hold \$740 — if it does, the uptrend is intact.

WHAT I'D DO WITH THIS STOCK

7/10 Conviction Score

CONVICTION: 7/10 — I like the story a lot, but insider selling and near-highs pricing keeps me from pounding the table.

POSITION SIZE: 4-6% of portfolio — big enough to matter, small enough that if the FTC surprise happens, you're not wrecked.

ENTRY POINTS: I'd add on pullbacks to \$720-735. If it breaks \$700, back up the truck (barring a specific bad news catalyst).

TIME HORIZON: 12-24 months. Key catalyst: Q4 earnings in late January will show whether AI capex is translating to ad revenue growth.

WHEN TO BAIL: If ad revenue growth drops below 10% YoY, or if the FTC forces an Instagram spinoff, or if Zuck announces ANOTHER doubling of capex without revenue to match — I'm out.

HEDGING: Simplest hedge: buy put options 10% below current price as insurance (costs a few percent, protects you from a crash). Or pair-trade by shorting a weaker ad name like SNAP against your META long.

Micron Technology, Inc.

MU NASDAQ

Buy	\$1081.87 ▲ 0.12%	12M Price Target \$1250.00	52-Week Range \$155.18 – \$1255.00	Market Cap \$1.22T
-----	-------------------	-------------------------------	---------------------------------------	-----------------------

MU: AI Memory Monster Heads Into Make-or-Break Earnings

WHAT HAPPENED

- Stock is basically flat today (+0.12%) but that's masking real drama — MU is up 279% YTD heading into earnings, and the news flow is mixed. Quartz is flagging that the NVIDIA chip launch benefit might be delayed (bad), while IBD says memory stocks are trying to break out (good). Translation: the market is holding its breath before the earnings print.
- The options tape is screaming caution — put/call ratio is 0.60 overall (bullish-looking) but there's a MASSIVE unusual call buy at \$1080 strike expiring this week (31k contracts, 12.8x open interest) paired with big put buys at \$1090 and \$1100. That's not directional betting — that's traders straddling the earnings, meaning they expect a big move but don't know which way.

WHY IT MATTERS

Here's the real story: MU is up 279% because HBM memory (the specialized chips that feed AI processors) went from commodity to critical, and Micron is one of only three players globally that can make it. But the stock is now at 84% of its 52-week range with a \$1.22T market cap — meaning a LOT of good news is priced in. The Quartz headline about "delayed NVIDIA benefit" is the market's biggest fear crystallized: if Micron's HBM3E revenue ramp slips a quarter because NVIDIA's next chip is late, the multiple compression could be brutal. That said, the CHIPS Act subsidies and the Biden/Trump-era bipartisan consensus on domestic semiconductor manufacturing means Micron has a policy floor under it that didn't exist two years ago — this isn't a normal cyclical anymore.

POLICY & POLITICAL WATCH

Two big things moving right now: (1) The CHIPS Act 2.0 discussions in Congress — an expansion of the original \$52B semiconductor subsidy package — would be a direct tailwind since Micron already has ~\$6B in awards for Idaho and New York fabs. (2) The China angle is heating up: CXMT (China's memory champion) is ramping commodity DRAM production, and there's active debate in Washington about tightening export controls AND slapping tariffs on Chinese memory imports. If tariffs pass, Micron's pricing power on legacy DRAM improves; if CXMT floods the market unchecked, margins on non-HBM products get squeezed. Also watch the U.S.-Iran peace talks headline — geopolitical risk-off is a small positive for cyclical stocks like MU.

IS IT EXPENSIVE?

Key Data

Price (USD)	\$1081.87
12M Price Target	\$1250.00
Upside / (Downside)	+15.5%
Market Cap	\$1.22T
FY2026E Revenue	\$52,000M
FY2027E Revenue	\$68,000M
FY2026E EPS	\$14.20
FY2027E EPS	\$21.50
Fwd P/E	76.2x

INVESTMENT PROFILE



12-MONTH PRICE PERFORMANCE VS. S&P; 500



PRICE OUTLOOK — SCENARIO TARGETS BY TIMEFRAME

TIMEFRAME	BULL CASE	BASE CASE	BEAR CASE
1 Month	\$1200.00	\$1100.00	\$950.00
6 Months	\$1400.00	\$1200.00	\$850.00
1 Year	\$1600.00	\$1250.00	\$750.00
2 Years	\$2000.00	\$1500.00	\$650.00
5 Years	\$3000.00	\$2200.00	\$500.00
10 Years	\$5000.00	\$3500.00	\$400.00

WHAT'S MOVING IN THE SECTOR

HEATING UP: Technology (+3.95% over 5 days) is clearly the belle of the ball — AI infrastructure spending remains the dominant narrative and semis are leading. Industrials also strong (+0.91%) on defense/reshoring themes tied to CHIPS Act manufacturing buildout.

COOLING OFF: Financials weakening (-1.55% over 5 days) as rate cut expectations shift; Consumer Staples flat as money flees defensives for growth.

ROTATION WATCH: Money is aggressively rotating INTO AI-adjacent semis and OUT of defensives — this is a "risk-on" tape driven by peace talks (Iran) and continued AI capex commitments from hyperscalers. Direct tailwind for MU.

RELATED PLAY: If MU rips, the picks-and-shovels of the memory business — companies like Applied Materials (AMAT) and Lam Research (LRCX) that make the equipment for HBM production — get a second-order lift.

WHO'S WINNING IN THIS SPACE?

- NVDA (NVIDIA): Still the anchor tenant of the AI trade — MU's HBM goes directly into NVDA GPUs, so their fates are linked
 - SNDK (Sandisk): IBD called it out today as trying to clear a buy point alongside MU — memory rally is broadening
- MU CONTEXT:** MU is LEADING its peer group with 279% YTD gains — that's both bullish (momentum) and dangerous (extended). When a stock leads this hard into earnings, the bar is sky-high. Any miss gets punished disproportionately.

WHAT I'D DO WITH THIS STOCK

7/10 Conviction Score

Position Size: 3-5% of portfolio

Entry Points: \$1000-1040 on pullbacks

Time Horizon: 12-24 months

Thesis Invalidation: HBM pricing collapse, NVDA delays materialize, or China's CXMT floods commodity DRAM

Hedging: Buy protective puts around earnings or pair with short position in commodity DRAM peer

Tesla, Inc.
TSLA NASDAQ

Hold	\$372.57 ▼ 1.42%	12M Price Target \$410.00	52-Week Range \$297.38 – \$498.83	Market Cap \$1.47T
------	------------------	------------------------------	--------------------------------------	-----------------------

TSLA: Semi Launches, But EU FSD Delay Stings

WHAT HAPPENED

- Stock dropped ~1.4% on decent volume — the headline culprit is Musk publicly griping about the EU dragging its feet on Full Self-Driving (FSD) approval. That matters because Europe was supposed to be the next big FSD revenue unlock, and every quarter of delay = subscription revenue that doesn't show up in the model.
- Semi truck deliveries finally started — but Tesla gave a production target with NO timeline, which Wall Street reads as "we're not sure when this scales." Classic Tesla: real product, fuzzy math.

WHY IT MATTERS

Here's the tension: the options market is screaming bullish (call buying 2x put buying, with massive unusual call activity at the \$370-372.5 strikes) while the actual news flow is mixed. That tells me traders are positioning for a catalyst — likely the US-China state dinner where Musk had a seat at the table. If Musk walks away with softer China rhetoric or tariff carve-outs for Tesla's Shanghai operations, that's a real tailwind because Tesla builds ~50% of its global vehicles in China. But the EU FSD delay is the bigger structural worry — the bull case on this stock isn't cars, it's autonomy revenue at software-like margins, and every regulatory delay compresses that timeline.

POLICY & POLITICAL WATCH

Three policy vectors are moving right now: (1) The US-China dinner Musk attended suggests the Trump administration is using CEO diplomacy to negotiate — watch for tariff relief on Chinese-made EV components, which would juice Tesla margins. (2) The \$7,500 federal EV tax credit was already gutted earlier in the Trump term, and Tesla has quietly benefited because it hurt smaller competitors more (Tesla has scale, Rivian/Lucid don't). (3) The EU's AI Act and vehicle autonomy rules are the real overhang — if Brussels keeps stalling FSD approval into 2027, analysts will start cutting the "autonomy" portion of Tesla's valuation, which is doing a lot of heavy lifting at a \$1.47T market cap.

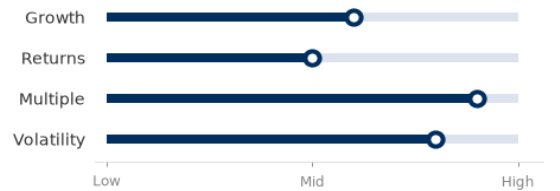
IS IT EXPENSIVE?

At ~\$372, you're paying roughly 130x forward earnings — meaning investors are shelling out \$130 for every \$1 of profit Tesla will make next year. For comparison, Toyota trades around 10x and even Nvidia trades around 35x. That premium only makes sense if you believe robotaxis, Optimus robots, and FSD subscriptions will turn Tesla into a software/AI company, not a car company. Right now the stock is at 37% of its 52-week range — not cheap, not euphoric, kind of stuck in "prove it" territory.

Key Data

Price (USD)	\$372.57
12M Price Target	\$410.00
Upside / (Downside)	+10.0%
Market Cap	\$1.47T
FY2026E Revenue	\$118M
FY2027E Revenue	\$145M
FY2026E EPS	\$2.85
FY2027E EPS	\$4.20
Fwd P/E	130.7x

INVESTMENT PROFILE



12-MONTH PRICE PERFORMANCE VS. S&P 500



PRICE OUTLOOK — SCENARIO TARGETS BY TIMEFRAME

TIMEFRAME	BULL CASE	BASE CASE	BEAR CASE
1 Month	\$405.00	\$380.00	\$345.00
6 Months	\$460.00	\$400.00	\$320.00
1 Year	\$520.00	\$410.00	\$290.00
2 Years	\$650.00	\$460.00	\$250.00
5 Years	\$900.00	\$550.00	\$220.00
10 Years	\$1400.00	\$700.00	\$180.00

WHAT'S MOVING IN THE SECTOR

HEATING UP: Tech (+1.1% today, +3.95% over 5 days) — the Trump-Xi tech CEO dinner is being read as de-escalation, and money is flowing back into names with China exposure. Industrials also strong on infrastructure/reshoring narrative.

COOLING OFF: Financials cooling on rate uncertainty; Consumer Staples flat as investors chase growth.

ROTATION WATCH: Money is rotating INTO AI/tech infrastructure and OUT of defensive names — that's normally good for TSLA, but Tesla is underperforming its own sector today, which suggests stock-specific concerns (FSD delay) are outweighing the tailwind.

RELATED PLAY: If you like the China-thaw thesis but don't want single-stock risk, semiconductor equipment names (AMAT, LRCX) benefit from any easing of export restrictions. Also watch charging infrastructure plays.

WHO'S WINNING IN THIS SPACE?

- NVDA (Nvidia): Riding the AI infrastructure wave and got the friendliest China signals from the dinner
- GOOGL (Alphabet): Waymo continues to lap Tesla in actual deployed robotaxi miles, which is starting to matter to investors

TSLA CONTEXT: Tesla is LAGGING its tech peers today despite Musk getting a coveted head-table seat at the state dinner. That's a yellow flag — when a stock can't rally on good news, it usually means positioning is already crowded long and the market wants a bigger catalyst than dinner photos.

WHAT I'D DO WITH THIS STOCK

6/10 Conviction Score

CONVICTION: 6/10 — I like the long-term AI optionality but the valuation gives me no margin for error, and near-term catalysts are mixed.

POSITION SIZE: 2-4% of portfolio — this stock can move 5% on a tweet, so size it where a bad week doesn't ruin your month.

ENTRY POINTS: I'd wait for pullbacks to \$340-355, which is where the stock has found support recently. Chasing at \$372 into an FSD delay headline feels sloppy.

TIME HORIZON: 12-24 months — the real catalyst is FSD regulatory clarity in EU/China plus a credible robotaxi revenue number. That's a 2027 story.

WHEN TO BAIL: If auto gross margin drops below 15%, or if EU FSD approval gets pushed past mid-2027, or if Musk cluster-sells insider shares (right now it's just the CFO trimming, which is normal).

HEDGING: Buy some protective puts before earnings — think of it as insurance on your house. Costs a little, saves you a lot if things go wrong. Or pair the long with a short in a legacy automaker to isolate the "Tesla is different" thesis.

NVIDIA Corporation

NVDA NASDAQ

Buy

\$225.04 ▲ 0.20%

12M Price Target
\$260.00

52-Week Range
\$164.27 – \$236.54

Market Cap
\$5.43T

NVDA: Steady at Highs as US-China Dinner Sets Tone

WHAT HAPPENED

- Stock basically flat (\$225, +0.20%) but sitting near the 52-week high — the interesting tell is volume collapsed to 47M shares vs 90-110M all week. That's classic "everyone's waiting" behavior, likely for the US-China state dinner headlines (Jensen Huang is reportedly among the 30+ CEOs invited, and this matters HUGE for NVDA's China chip access).
- Micron's earnings note suggests the "Nvidia chip launch benefit may be delayed" — meaning the next-gen memory ramp tied to NVDA's new chips is slipping a quarter. Small negative but explains why buyers aren't chasing here.

WHY IT MATTERS

The setup here is unusually loaded. You've got Jensen at the head table of a US-China state dinner while Iran peace talks are simultaneously lifting risk appetite — this is a "diplomacy dividend" environment, and NVDA is the single most geopolitically-sensitive megacap because ~13% of revenue was historically China-exposed before export controls. If the dinner produces even a modest thaw on chip export rules (think: H20 successor gets green-lit for China), that's an instant \$15-20B revenue unlock nobody has in models. On the flip side, the cluster of insider selling (Director Mark Stevens dumped \$298M last week) tells you people close to the company think near-term upside is capped — they're not panicking, they're taking chips off a very high table.

POLICY & POLITICAL WATCH

The big one is TODAY's US-China state dinner — watch for any language on semiconductor export controls. The Biden-era chip restrictions were softened earlier this year but H200/Blackwell exports to China are still gated; any easing = pure upside. Secondly, the CHIPS Act 2.0 discussions in the Senate around domestic AI infrastructure grants (\$40B+ proposed) directly funnel demand to NVDA's data center business — if that moves in Q4, it's a tailwind. Risk on the other side: the FTC is still sniffing around NVDA's CUDA software moat as a potential antitrust issue, though nothing imminent.

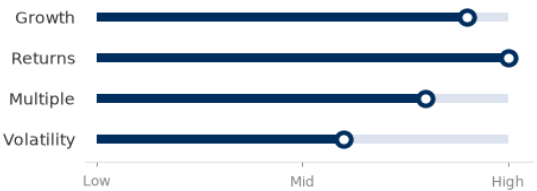
IS IT EXPENSIVE?

At \$5.43T market cap and roughly 46x forward earnings, you're paying \$46 for every \$1 of next year's profit — expensive on the surface, but earnings are growing ~35% annually so the PEG ratio (price-to-growth) is actually reasonable around 1.3x. Compared to other AI infrastructure names trading at 60-80x with slower growth, NVDA is actually the "cheap" quality name in the group. The valuation only breaks if data center capex from Microsoft/Meta/Google/Amazon plateaus — and their guides all point the opposite direction.

Key Data

Price (USD)	\$225.04
12M Price Target	\$260.00
Upside / (Downside)	+15.5%
Market Cap	\$5.43T
FY2026E Revenue	\$205M
FY2027E Revenue	\$275M
FY2026E EPS	\$4.85
FY2027E EPS	\$6.60
Fwd P/E	46.4x

INVESTMENT PROFILE



12-MONTH PRICE PERFORMANCE VS. S&P 500



PRICE OUTLOOK — SCENARIO TARGETS BY TIMEFRAME

TIMEFRAME	BULL CASE	BASE CASE	BEAR CASE
1 Month	\$245.00	\$232.00	\$210.00
6 Months	\$275.00	\$250.00	\$195.00
1 Year	\$310.00	\$260.00	\$180.00
2 Years	\$380.00	\$300.00	\$165.00
5 Years	\$550.00	\$400.00	\$150.00
10 Years	\$900.00	\$600.00	\$140.00

WHAT'S MOVING IN THE SECTOR

HEATING UP: Tech (+3.95% on the week) leading everything, driven by AI infra names and the risk-on tone from Iran peace headlines. Industrials also perking up on the same diplomatic optimism.

COOLING OFF: Financials down 1.55% on the week — rate cut expectations are compressing net interest margin outlooks. Staples soft too, classic risk-on rotation away from defensives.

ROTATION WATCH: Money is flowing INTO AI/tech and OUT OF defensive yield plays — this is the "goldilocks" setup for NVDA where both macro (rate cuts coming) and micro (AI demand) align.

RELATED PLAY: If NVDA runs, the power and cooling infrastructure names (VRT, ETN, GEV) benefit — data centers need 3-4x more electricity than traditional ones, and that's the second-order trade nobody talks about.

WHO'S WINNING IN THIS SPACE?

- AVGO (Broadcom): Winning on custom AI chip deals with hyperscalers — the "if you can't beat NVDA, hire AVGO to build your alternative" trade.
- ANET (Arista Networks): Called out in today's IBD coverage as approaching a buy point — networking is the second-derivative AI play as data centers scale.

NVDA CONTEXT: NVDA is neither leading nor lagging — it's the anchor. When it consolidates like this at highs, capital rotates into second-derivative names (ANET, VRT, AVGO). That's actually healthy — it means the AI trade is broadening, not topping. When NVDA breaks \$236 (52-week high), the whole complex likely follows.

WHAT I'D DO WITH THIS STOCK

8/10 Conviction Score

CONVICTION: 8/10 — Highest quality name in the highest-quality theme, with a genuine near-term policy catalyst. Not a 10 only because we're near all-time highs and insiders are selling.

POSITION SIZE: 5-7% — this deserves a core position but the volatility means don't go crazy. If you're already at 7%, don't add.

ENTRY POINTS: Add on pullbacks to \$210-215 (the 50-day area). Don't chase above \$232 into the 52-week high — let it break out with volume first.

TIME HORIZON: 12-24 months. Near-term catalyst is the US-China dinner outcome + Q3 earnings in November. Longer-term catalyst is Blackwell Ultra ramp in 2027.

WHEN TO BAIL: If any hyperscaler guides data center capex DOWN, or if China export controls TIGHTEN post-dinner, trim aggressively. A close below \$200 breaks the uptrend.

HEDGING: Buy some cheap January puts ~15% below current price as insurance — costs you about 2% of your position value but caps your downside if the AI trade unwinds suddenly. Think of it like fire insurance on a house you love.

Alphabet Inc.

GOOGL NASDAQ

Buy

\$344.54 ▲ 0.64%

12M Price Target
\$385.00

52-Week Range
\$235.84 – \$408.61

Market Cap
\$4.21T

GOOGL: Space Data Centers and TPU Moat Widen the Story

WHAT HAPPENED

- Stock bouncing back (+0.64%) after a rough Tuesday where it dropped almost 4%. The rebound is riding on two things: (1) news that Google's launching a mini data center into SPACE next week as part of "Project Suncatcher" — solar-powered TPUs in orbit, sounds sci-fi but it's a real answer to the power bottleneck everyone in AI is hitting, and (2) broader tech sector strength (+1.10% today).
- The scarier headline in the background: Oracle filed a "force majeure" notice on some AI contracts (basically saying "we can't deliver because circumstances outside our control"). That's spooking the market about whether AI capex spending is sustainable — but Alphabet is actually the winner here because they build their own chips (TPUs) instead of depending on Nvidia supply like ORCL does.

WHY IT MATTERS

The Suncatcher space data center thing sounds gimmicky but the underlying message matters: Alphabet is telling investors they've thought through the power problem that's about to strangle everyone else's AI ambitions. That's a real competitive moat because US data center power demand is projected to consume grid capacity faster than utilities can build it. Meanwhile the Oracle "force majeure" story is a canary in the coal mine for AI infrastructure names that OVER-promised — expect capital to rotate FROM speculative AI infra names INTO the hyperscalers who actually generate cash (GOOGL, MSFT, META). Options flow confirms this: put/call ratio of 0.34 is aggressively bullish, and someone bought 11,578 near-the-money calls expiring this week — that's not retail, that's institutional positioning into something.

POLICY & POLITICAL WATCH

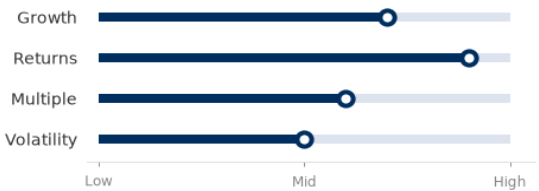
The big overhang — the DOJ antitrust case on Search — has quietly become less scary; the remedy phase looks headed toward behavioral fixes (data sharing, default search choices) rather than a forced breakup of Chrome or Android, which is a huge relief. Watch the Trump administration's AI Action Plan and the pending "AI Diffusion Rule" revisions — the current White House is leaning toward loosening chip export restrictions and treating AI leadership as a national security priority, which favors US hyperscalers that can be trusted allies for federal cloud contracts (JWCC contract is the one to watch). On the flip side, the EU Digital Markets Act keeps racking up fines — expect another €1-3B headline sometime in Q4, but that's now priced in and small vs. Alphabet's \$100B+ annual cash flow.

IS IT EXPENSIVE?

Key Data

Price (USD)	\$344.54
12M Price Target	\$385.00
Upside / (Downside)	+11.7%
Market Cap	\$4.21T
FY2026E Revenue	\$415M
FY2027E Revenue	\$470M
FY2026E EPS	\$9.85
FY2027E EPS	\$11.60
Fwd P/E	35.0x

INVESTMENT PROFILE



12-MONTH PRICE PERFORMANCE VS. S&P 500



PRICE OUTLOOK — SCENARIO TARGETS BY TIMEFRAME

TIMEFRAME	BULL CASE	BASE CASE	BEAR CASE
1 Month	\$365.00	\$350.00	\$325.00
6 Months	\$400.00	\$370.00	\$310.00
1 Year	\$430.00	\$385.00	\$290.00
2 Years	\$500.00	\$425.00	\$275.00
5 Years	\$700.00	\$550.00	\$300.00
10 Years	\$1100.00	\$800.00	\$350.00

WHAT'S MOVING IN THE SECTOR

HEATING UP: Technology (+1.10% today, +3.95% for the week) — AI infrastructure narrative is back after last week's wobble, and the current administration's pro-tech, pro-AI-dominance stance is providing a policy tailwind. Industrials also perking up on infrastructure spending.

COOLING OFF: Financials (-1.55% over 5 days) — rate cut expectations getting pushed out is compressing net interest margins. Consumer Staples flat/down as defensive money rotates OUT and into growth.

ROTATION WATCH: Money is clearly moving from speculative AI infra (Oracle-type names getting hit on the force majeure headline) into the profitable hyperscalers that print cash. That's a direct tailwind for GOOGL, MSFT, and META.

RELATED PLAY: If the "own your own chips" narrative gains traction, watch Broadcom (AVGO) — they make custom silicon for Google's TPUs and are a picks-and-shovels way to play the same theme.

WHO'S WINNING IN THIS SPACE?

- NVDA (Nvidia): Still the AI king, but starting to hear "peak dependency" chatter as hyperscalers build their own chips
- META (Meta Platforms): Riding AI ad-targeting improvements + Reality Labs finally showing traction

GOOGL CONTEXT: Alphabet has been a LAGGARD among Mag 7 for most of 2025 due to antitrust fear, but that discount is now closing. It's the "catch-up trade" within the group — if you missed the NVDA/META run, this is where relative value lives.

WHAT I'D DO WITH THIS STOCK

8/10 Conviction Score

Position Size: 4-6% of portfolio

Entry Points: \$335-342 on pullbacks

Time Horizon: 12-24 months

Thesis Invalidation: Cloud growth decelerates below 25% YoY, or DOJ forces Chrome/Android divestiture

Hedging: Long-dated puts or pair with short position in a richly-valued AI infra name (e.g., ORCL)

Marvell Technology, Inc.

MRVL NASDAQ

Hold	\$266.00 ▲ 2.72%	12M Price Target \$285.00	52-Week Range \$70.69 – \$329.88	Market Cap \$239.06B
------	------------------	------------------------------	-------------------------------------	-------------------------

MRVL: AI Optical Momentum Meets Valuation Reality Check

WHAT HAPPENED

- MRVL popped 2.7% on light volume (only 7M shares vs 20M+ earlier this week) — that's a "grinding higher" tape, not a stampede. The move looks tied to fresh AI optical news (Simply Wall St flagged it) and being lumped in with NVDA in today's "AI winners" narrative from Barron's.
- The Simply Wall St note actually said "may be fully priced" — meaning even bullish coverage is starting to hedge. When the good news gets called expensive, that's a yellow flag worth noting.

WHY IT MATTERS

Here's what I'm reading: MRVL is now sitting at 75% of its 52-week range after nearly quadrupling off the lows (\$70 → \$266), and the options market is screaming bullish (put/call ratio 0.43, meaning traders are buying 2.3 call bets for every put — they're positioning for more upside). But the light volume on today's rally tells me conviction buying is thinning out — the easy money has been made. The bigger picture: MRVL's story is now 100% tethered to hyperscaler AI capex (Amazon, Microsoft, Meta, Google building AI data centers) and their custom silicon partnership with AWS on Trainium chips. That's a massive tailwind while it lasts, but it also means any hyperscaler capex "digestion" phase — even a normal one — gets punished hard at this multiple.

POLICY & POLITICAL WATCH

The single biggest policy variable for MRVL right now is US-China semiconductor export controls — the Commerce Department has been progressively tightening rules on advanced networking and AI chips shipped to China, and MRVL's data center segment has China exposure that could get squeezed further. On the tailwind side, the CHIPS Act implementation continues to funnel money into domestic semi manufacturing and the AI Diffusion Rule framework favors US-designed silicon in allied countries — MRVL benefits from both. Watch for any Treasury/Commerce announcements this fall on expanded entity lists; a surprise tightening could clip 5-10% off the stock in a session.

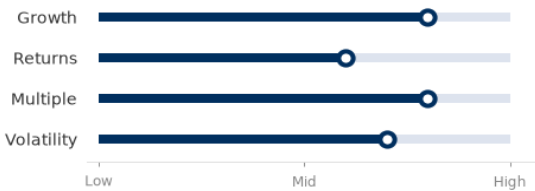
IS IT EXPENSIVE?

At \$266 and a \$239B market cap, investors are paying roughly 29x next year's expected revenue and around 93x forward earnings — meaning you're paying \$93 for every \$1 of profit MRVL will make next year. That's expensive even for AI-adjacent names (NVDA trades cheaper on forward earnings). The valuation only works if custom silicon revenue with AWS/Microsoft ramps faster than consensus AND optical DSP share gains continue — otherwise there's no margin for error.

Key Data

Price (USD)	\$266.00
12M Price Target	\$285.00
Upside / (Downside)	+7.1%
Market Cap	\$239.06B
FY2026E Revenue	\$8,200M
FY2027E Revenue	\$10,500M
FY2026E EPS	\$2.85
FY2027E EPS	\$4.20
Fwd P/E	93.3x

INVESTMENT PROFILE



12-MONTH PRICE PERFORMANCE VS. S&P 500



PRICE OUTLOOK — SCENARIO TARGETS BY TIMEFRAME

TIMEFRAME	BULL CASE	BASE CASE	BEAR CASE
1 Month	\$285.00	\$270.00	\$245.00
6 Months	\$320.00	\$285.00	\$220.00
1 Year	\$365.00	\$300.00	\$200.00
2 Years	\$450.00	\$340.00	\$180.00
5 Years	\$600.00	\$425.00	\$200.00
10 Years	\$900.00	\$550.00	\$175.00

WHAT'S MOVING IN THE SECTOR

HEATING UP: Technology (+3.95% over 5 days) is the clear leader — money is flowing back into AI infrastructure names as investors get comfortable that hyperscaler capex isn't slowing in 2027. Industrials also getting a bid on defense/reshoring policy tailwinds.

COOLING OFF: Financials (-1.55% over 5 days) are lagging as rate cut expectations get pushed out, and Consumer Staples are drifting on weakening defensive demand.

ROTATION WATCH: Classic risk-on rotation into semis and AI — the money leaving defensives is chasing tech beta. This directly benefits MRVL but also means it moves with sector sentiment, not just fundamentals.

RELATED PLAY: If MRVL's optical story keeps winning, watch Coherent (COHR) and Lumentum (LITE) — they make the actual optical components that ride the same data center buildout wave, and they trade cheaper.

WHO'S WINNING IN THIS SPACE?

- NVDA (Nvidia): Still the AI benchmark — every hyperscaler earnings call reinforces demand for their GPUs, and MRVL rides that same wave.
- AVGO (Broadcom): The direct custom silicon competitor — winning big deals with Google and now reportedly Meta, which is both a validation of the space AND MRVL's biggest threat.

MRVL CONTEXT: MRVL has been leading its peer group in percentage terms off the lows (up ~275% from \$70), but it's now catching up to Broadcom on valuation — meaning the "cheap AI beta" trade is over. From here it needs to earn each dollar of upside with actual execution, not just multiple expansion.

WHAT I'D DO WITH THIS STOCK

6/10 Conviction Score

CONVICTION: 6/10 — I like the business, I don't love the entry price. The story is real but the risk/reward at \$266 is symmetric, not skewed.

POSITION SIZE: 2-4% of portfolio — meaningful enough to matter, small enough to survive a 25% drawdown without wrecking your year.

ENTRY POINTS: I'd wait for pullbacks to \$240-250 (roughly the 50-day trend area) before adding. Chasing \$266 into resistance with light volume isn't the trade.

TIME HORIZON: 12-24 months — the catalyst is AWS Trainium ramp visibility and next hyperscaler design win announcement, likely in the next 2-3 earnings cycles.

WHEN TO BAIL: If MRVL loses an AWS custom silicon renewal, if China export rules tighten materially on their networking chips, or if guidance signals hyperscaler orders are decelerating — any of those and I'm cutting.

HEDGING: Simplest hedge — buy a small position in put options 10-15% out of the money as insurance (think of it like fire insurance on your house — you hope you don't need it). Or pair the position with a short in the semi ETF (SMH) to isolate MRVL-specific upside.

The following stocks were identified by screening a curated universe against the current watchlist's investment themes, today's macro environment, and smart-money signals. Scores reflect theme alignment, momentum, valuation, and institutional flow. These are research leads — not investment advice.

1	QCOM QUALCOMM Incorporated Semiconductors	8.6/10	BUY
Price: \$204.51 · 1M: +28.1% · P/S: 5.0x · Cap: \$218.4B			
■ Add to watchlist via tickers.txt			
OPT:BULL INS:NEUT INST:BULL			
2	INTC Intel Corporation Semiconductors	8.5/10	WATCH
Price: \$124.44 · 1M: +42.2% · P/S: 11.5x · Cap: \$657.8B			
■ Monitor for pullback to \$135 entry			
OPT:BULL INS:NEUT INST:BULL			
3	ARM Arm Holdings plc Semiconductors	8.0/10	WATCH
Price: \$317.00 · 1M: +31.2% · P/S: 65.7x · Cap: \$338.6B			
■ Monitor for pullback to \$155 entry			
OPT:BULL INS:NEUT INST:BULL			
4	GTLB GitLab Inc. AI & Machine Learning	7.9/10	BUY
Price: \$47.76 · 1M: +14.6% · P/S: 7.5x · Cap: \$8.0B			
■ Add to watchlist via tickers.txt			
OPT:BULL INS:NEUT INST:BULL			
5	SAIC Science Applications International Defense Technology	7.3/10	BUY
Price: \$132.69 · 1M: +4.2% · P/S: 0.8x · Cap: \$5.6B			
■ Add to watchlist via tickers.txt			
OPT:NEUT INS:NEUT INST:BULL			